

government's aim to double the consumption of CNG and PNG by 2030 will boost the gas sector," says Goel. Crude oil prices have tanked to nearly \$60 per barrel from \$75 levels in a week as Trump tariffs increase the chances of a recession.

Overall, the period of easy gains in the domestic equity market seems to be over, prompting equity investors to stay company or business-specific and explore other asset classes such as precious metals (gold and silver), fixed income and real estate.

THE SHINING STARS

Gold and silver emerged as shining stars in FY25 with a 30%-plus rally triggered by escalating geopolitical tensions, strong buying by central banks, rising inflation, economic uncertainties and increasing interest in ETFs. In India, gold ETFs saw a net inflow of ₹14,929 crore in FY25 till February, as against ₹5,248 crore a year ago. In 2024, central banks purchased a record 1,180 tonnes of gold, surpassing the tally of 1,082 tonnes in 2022 and 1,037 tonnes in 2023, according to the World Gold Council. The price of the yellow metal was ₹88,691 per 10 gm on March 31, 2025, compared to ₹66,746 per 10 gm on March 28, 2024. Gold was trading around ₹90,000 per 10 gm on April 4, 2025. The white metal was at ₹1 lakh per kg on March 31, 2025, as against ₹73,867 per kg on March 28, 2024.

"The trend for the coming year is likely to be bullish. The US administration's trade policies with major partners along and the Fed's stance on interest rate for the year could be pivotal. If rate cuts continue or are paused at lower levels,



"Investors can expect volatility in the backdrop of global uncertainty. One should invest keeping in mind that decent returns are likely in FY27 or FY28"

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DVP AND HEAD OF
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the reduced opportunity cost of holding gold will sustain its appeal," says Jigar Trivedi, Senior Analyst, Reliance Securities.

The other important factors that will decide gold's price are the strength of the US dollar, geopolitical developments, buying by central banks and the Fed's inflation expectations. "Silver is likely to be driven by industrial demand. The global push for renewable energy—solar panels, batteries, and elec-



"Export-oriented companies may face challenges due to (global) trade disruptions, and it will be difficult to predict their growth and stability"

SHREYASH DEVALKAR
HEAD-EQUITY, AXIS
MUTUAL FUND

tronics—will likely lead to a deficit. An acceleration in spending on green infrastructure could amplify the trend. Silver often moves in tandem with gold, but with higher volatility. If gold maintains its upward trajectory, silver could also give outsized gains," says Trivedi.

Naveen Mathur, Director, Commodities and Currencies, Anand Rathi Shares and Stock Brokers, says Trump's protectionist policies created uncertainty and encour-